

CLS Requests — User Guide

Current Level of Service budget requests • Beacon Performance & Budgeting • Agency Writers, Agency Approvers, BBMR Reviewers

What a CLS request is

A Current Level of Service (CLS) request asks BBMR to fund the cost of maintaining your agency's current level of service next fiscal year — a mandated cost increase, a cyclical cost, extraordinary inflation, and so on. Requests are summarized by initiative or project rather than broken out by individual spend category: you give one total for the request, then break that total out by expenditure object and, where relevant, by position.

Who does what

Role	Can do	Where
Agency Writer	Create and fill in requests; submit a request to the Agency Approver.	CLS Requests
Agency Approver	Everything a writer can do, plus send an individual request on to BBMR.	CLS Requests
BBMR Reviewer	Review submitted requests, record analyst notes and the BBMR decision; may also open and edit a request.	CLS Review
Agency Viewer	Read-only access to the agency's requests.	CLS Requests

How a request moves

Status	Set when	Who
In Progress	the request is created	Writer
Agency Review	Submit is selected on that request	Writer
BBMR Review	Send to BBMR is selected on that request	Approver
Approved / Partially Approved / Denied	the BBMR approval is recorded	BBMR Reviewer

Each request moves on its own — submitting one does not submit the rest. Only requests approved by an Agency Approver reach BBMR for review.

For Agency Writers

You do the data entry: create each request, describe it, and break the money out. When a request is complete, you submit it to your Agency Approver.

Start a request

- 1 In the left navigation under **Budget Planning**, choose **CLS Requests**. The page is titled with your agency name and lists every request your agency has created.
- 2 Select **Add CLS Request**. This opens a full request page — there are no pop-ups.

Fill in the summary

- 1 **Request name** — name the initiative. The page heading and the sentence above the form update as you type.
- 2 **Service** — choose the service in your agency the request supports.
- 3 **Request type** — choose the adjustment type. Select the ☐ icon beside the label if you are unsure; the full reference table opens directly below the field (see the next page).
- 4 **Request duration** — the toggle reads **Recurring Request** by default. Switch it on for a **One-Time Request**; the FY29 and FY30 fields are then hidden and cleared. The ☐ icon here explains when a multi-year contract counts as recurring.
- 5 **FY28 / FY29 / FY30 Amount** — the FY28 amount is the request total. FY29 and FY30 are the projected amounts and should assume any year-over-year increase.
- 6 **Summarize the request** — required. Three to four sentences, **150-word limit**. The counter beneath the box turns red and tells you the exact overage if you go long; anything past 150 words is cut off for review.
- 7 Select **Create request**. From then on the page **saves automatically** as you type — there is no Save button. The indicator beside the back link shows when it last saved; hover it to see who saved.

Break the money out

A banner above **Request details** tracks whether the money is fully explained. It reads “The total request needs to explain \$...” while there is money left, turns green when it balances, and warns “The total request exceeds \$...” if the parts add up to more than the FY28 amount. **Both objects and positions count toward that total.**

- 1 Under **Request details**, pick an **Object**, enter its **Amount**, and give a one-line **Justification**. Select **Add Details**. Use one line per object.
- 2 Repeat until the banner confirms the request is fully described.
- 3 If the request creates positions, tick **Add positions to this request** (off by default) and complete the classification, number of positions, **Estimated Cost**, and the two justification fields. Unticking the box clears what you had started typing.

Submit it

- 1 Return to **CLS Requests** using the back link. If everything is filled in and the money balances, you will see a confirmation that the request has been justified.

- 2 On that request's row, select **Submit** and confirm. The status becomes **Agency Review** and your Agency Approver takes it from there.

If something is missing

Required fields you have left blank are outlined in **red**. The banner above Request details tells you how much of the request is still unexplained. A reminder near the top names your Agency Approver and the submission deadline.

Request type reference

Adjustment type	Use it for	Example
Annualization of Cost	Full-year funding for something funded for part of FY27.	A new lease funded for part of FY27 needs annualizing in FY28.
Capital Project	Operating cost for a capital project coming online in FY28.	A renovated facility reopens in FY28.
Cyclical Cost	Costs that recur by the nature of the service.	Election costs.
Debt Service	Projected changes to debt service in FY28.	Updating a conditional purchase agreement to the debt schedule.
Extraordinary Inflation	Costs growing faster than the standard CLS inflation adjustment.	Expenditures growing more than 5% from inflation.
Grant Match	Local match for a state or federal grant (not replacing lost grant funds).	The local match on a 3-year grant grows each year.
Mandated Cost	Increases driven by a legal or contractual mandate.	Operating costs from recent Council legislation.
Remove One-Time Item	Removing FY27 funding that was only ever for one year.	One-time equipment funding comes out of the base.

Expenditure objects

Transfers • Salaries • Other Personnel Costs • Contractual Services • Materials and Supplies • Minor Equipment (<\$5k) • Major Equipment (>\$5k) • Grants, Subsidies, and Contributions • Debt Service

For Agency Approvers

You see exactly the same pages and the same editing tools as an Agency Writer. The difference is the action on each row: instead of **Submit**, you get **Send to BBMR**. Nothing reaches BBMR until you send it.

Reviewing before you send

- 1 Open **CLS Requests**. Sort by **Status** to group everything sitting in **Agency Review**.
- 2 Select **Modify** on a request to open it. You can change anything a writer can — the name, service, type, duration, amounts, summary, objects and positions. Edits save automatically.
- 3 Check that the banner above **Request details** confirms the request is fully described. If it still says money needs explaining, the breakdown is incomplete.
- 4 Confirm the summary reads clearly and the justifications will make sense to someone outside the agency.

Sending a request to BBMR

- 1 Back on **CLS Requests**, select **Send to BBMR** on that request's row.
- 2 Confirm in the dialog, which names the request. The status becomes **BBMR Review** and the request is marked complete.
- 3 Send requests individually — sending one leaves the others untouched, so you can hold anything that is not ready.

After sending

The **Status** column is where you follow what happens next: it becomes **Approved**, **Partially Approved** or **Denied** once BBMR records a decision. Use **Export request(s)** below the table for an Excel workbook (request summary, line items, personnel on separate tabs) or a PDF of the full detail.

For BBMR Reviewers

You work from **CLS Review**, which spans every agency. Your notes and decision are stored separately from what the agency submitted, so the original request is never overwritten.

Reading the page

Card	What it counts
Pending Requests	Every CLS request, at any status.
Requests for Review	Only those an agency has sent to BBMR.
Total requested	Total dollars across those sent-to-BBMR requests.
Total positions	Total positions across those requests.

Beneath the cards, **Request volume** charts requested dollars by agency — hover a bar for that agency's request count. A labelled divider separates this overview from the review work below it.

Finding requests

- 1 Use the **Status** and **Agency** filters — both accept several values at once, and Status lists every status.
- 2 Select **Apply filters** to run them, or **Reset** to go back to everything.

Recording a decision

- 1 Select a row in **Review requests** to expand it. You see the service, type, FY28/29/30 amounts, duration, object and position rollups, and the agency's summary.
- 2 **Analyst approval** is advisory — it records the analyst's recommendation and does **not** change the request's status.
- 3 **BBMR approval** is the decision that counts: Approved, Partial or Denied. Saving it sets the request's status to **Approved**, **Partially Approved** or **Denied**, which the agency then sees.
- 4 Add **Analyst notes** as needed, then select **Save review**.
- 5 To see or change the request itself, select **Open request**. That opens the full request page, where you can edit it; the back link returns you to CLS Review.

What agencies see

Agencies do not see your analyst notes. They see the resulting **Status** on their CLS Requests page.

The screens

Schematic layouts. Field order and labels match the app; replace with screenshots when available.

Header: agency name, guidance text, + Add CLS Request
Table (sortable): Request name Service Amount (\$K/\$M) Status actions
Row actions: <i>Submit</i> (writer) or <i>Send to BBMR</i> (approver) • Delete • Modify →
Below the table: Export request(s) — Excel • PDF

Figure 1. The list page. The row action depends on your role and the request's status.

Top row: ← Back to CLS requests <i>Last Saved 7/29/26 at 2:45 PM</i> (hover for user)
Reminder: send to [Agency Approver] before the deadline
Summary: request name (title updates live) • intro sentence • Service • Request type ■ • Request duration toggle ■ • FY28 / FY29 / FY30 • Summarize the request (150 words)
Banner: total request needs to explain / exceeds / fully described
Request details: Object • Amount • Justification → <i>Add Details</i> , then the object table
Position requests: hidden until <i>Add positions to this request</i> is ticked

Figure 2. The request page. Everything for one request lives here; edits autosave.

Cards: Pending Requests • Requests for Review • Total requested • Total positions
Chart: requested dollars by agency (hover for counts)
— REVIEW —
Filters: Status (multi) • Agency (multi) • <i>Apply filters</i> • <i>Reset</i>
Table: Request Agency FY28 Status — select a row to expand
Expanded: submitted detail • Analyst approval (advisory) • BBMR approval (sets status) • Analyst notes • <i>Open request</i> • <i>Save review</i>

Figure 3. The BBMR review workspace.